Jonathon C. O. Mifsud

FWO Junior Postdoctoral Fellow • Laboratory of Clinical and Epidemiological Virology • Rega Institute, KU Leuven

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Education

The University of Sydney NSW, Australia

PhD, School of Medical Sciences — Jun 2021–Apr 2025

- Supervisor: Prof. Edward C. Holmes
- Co-supervisor: Dr. Erin Harvey
- Degree conferred Sep 2025

Macquarie University NSW, Australia

Master of Research, Biological Sciences — 2021

- Thesis: Explorations of the plant virosphere
- Mark: 92/100
- Supervisor: Prof. Rachael V. Gallagher
- Co-supervisor: Prof. Jemma L. Geoghegan

Bachelor of Advanced Science, Biology — 2018

Research Experience

KU Leuven Belgium

FWO Junior Postdoctoral Fellow — Oct 2026–present

Postdoctoral Researcher — Jun 2025–Sep 2026

Supervisor: Prof. Philippe Lemey

The University of Sydney NSW, Australia — Feb 2025–May 2025

Research Support

Supervisor: Prof. Edward C. Holmes

Grants and Scholarships

Junior Postdoctoral Fellowship, Research Foundation – Flanders (FWO) — 2026–2029

Postdoctoral Fellowship, Rega Institute — 2025–2026

Australian Government RTP Stipend, University of Sydney — 2022–2024

Postgraduate Research Support Scheme, University of Sydney ($1000) — 2024

Postgraduate Research Support Scheme, University of Sydney ($2796) — 2022

Postgraduate Research Scholarship in Virus Ecology and Evolution University of Sydney — 2021–2022

William Macleay Microbiology Research Fund, Linnean Society of NSW ($1,500) — 2020

RTP Master of Research Stipend, Macquarie University — 2019–2020

Professional Experience

Research Assistant

Phylagen, Inc — 2021

Hawkesbury Institute for the Environment, Western Sydney University — 2021

GenIMPACT, Macquarie University — 2020

Plant Ecology & Conservation Lab, Macquarie University — 2019–2020

Presentations

Invited talks/seminars

"The Promise and Challenges of Using Viral Protein Structural Information Across Deep Time" — 2026

SCMB Seminar Series, University of Queensland

"Mapping glycoprotein structure reveals *Flaviviridae* evolutionary history" — 2024

Virology "Wakate" Online Journal Club (virtual)

"Exploring the *Flaviviridae*: from virus discovery to phylogenetics and structural prediction" 2024

University of Glasgow

"Mining RNA viruses across the plant kingdom" 2023

Verena Lighthouse Lightning Talk Series (virtual)

Contributed talks

"The Promise and Challenges of Using Viral Protein Structural Information Across Deep Time" 2026

SMBE Australasian Protein Structural Phylogenetics Meeting

"Mapping glycoprotein structure reveals *Flaviviridae* evolutionary history" 2024

MicroSeq (virtual)

"Mapping glycoprotein structure reveals *Flaviviridae* evolutionary history" 2024

ViBioM, Leuven, Belgium

"Identification of a novel papillomavirus from a New Zealand fur seal with oral papilloma-like lesions" 2023

MicroSeq (virtual)

"Transcriptome mining extends the host range of the *Flaviviridae* to the basal Metazoa" 2022

Wellcome Virus Genomics and Evolution

Posters

Insights from small-scale transcriptome mining projects in Eukaryotes 2023

The RdRp Summit (virtual)

Mining public plant transcriptomes to reveal a diverse plant virosphere 2020

Wellcome Genome Informatics Conference (virtual)

Explorations of the plant virosphere 2020

Ecological Society of Australia 60th Anniversary Conference (virtual)

Honors and Awards

Peter Bancroft Prize for Research Work 2025

Microbial Genomics People's Choice Award for Best Medium talk 2024

Australian Virology Society Award for the Best Virology talk 2024

Australian Society for Microbiology Award for Best Lightning Talk 2023

Executive Dean's Commendation for Academic Excellence in Year 2 MRES 2021

Year 1 Biology prize for the best MRES Biology student overall 2019

Macquarie University Merit List 2019

300 Level Biology Prize for the best student overall 2018

Teaching and Service

Teaching

Peer Assisted Learning, Macquarie University 2017–2018
BIOL 115: Genes to Organisms
BIOL 122: Biological Basis of Behaviour

Outreach

Big Picture, Sydney Secondary College, Balmain, NSW, Australia 2023

Workshops

Macquarie University R-Users Group Committee 2020
Hosted and presented workshops and help sessions on Introductory R topics

Journal Reviewing

Microbiome, Nucleic Acids Research, Molecular Ecology, Virus Evolution, PLOS ONE, Archives of Virology, Environmental Microbiome

Publications For a complete and up-to-date list of publications, see my Google Scholar profile.